



SEEDSCALE · THE PLAYBOOK

How to Get Started with AI.

A practical playbook for solo founders, in-house marketers, and lean teams who are tired of hearing “just use AI” without knowing where to start.

\$9

For founders, operators & lean teams.



By Rebecca · Founder, Seedscale Agency

seedscale.agency · Marketing leverage for lean teams

If you're a team of one — or five — this is for you.

You don't need an AI strategy. You need a place to start.

This playbook is for the people running marketing without a team behind them. Solo founders. In-house marketers wearing every hat. Fractional CMOs. Agency owners trying to compound margin across clients. Anyone who's been told “just use AI” by twelve different people on LinkedIn and still doesn't know where to point the cursor.

What follows is the 80/20: the five places AI moves the needle hardest for lean teams, a 7-day plan to put it into motion, ten prompts you can paste into ChatGPT or Claude tonight, and the traps to avoid so you don't end up shipping slop.

The through-line

AI gives lean teams the output of a 10-person marketing department — without hiring one. The skill is knowing where to point it.

AI is leverage — not a replacement for judgment.

Stop asking AI to do the thinking.

The best operators don't ask AI “what should we do?” They ask AI to execute the thing they've already decided. The strategy is yours. AI is the leverage that turns it into output.

Treat it like a junior hire who never sleeps.

A junior employee needs context, examples, and tight feedback loops. So does the model. The teams getting 10x output aren't using better tools — they're writing better briefs.

Optimize for the second draft, not the first.

First drafts from AI are mediocre by design. The win is that you start at a second draft in 30 seconds instead of starting from blank in 30 minutes. Your editing is where the brand lives.

The five highest- leverage places to point AI today.

Most lean teams try to use AI everywhere and end up using it nowhere. The 80/20 lives in five places. Each one returns time, taste, or both — fast enough that you'll feel it inside a week. Pick the one that hurts most. Start there.

01

Content production

Outline → draft → edit. The single biggest time sink in lean marketing.

02

Email

Subject lines, body copy, sequences. AI is best where the structure repeats.

03

Customer research

Voice-of-customer mining from reviews, calls, and support tickets.

04

Calendar & ops

Planning, repurposing rules, content-to-channel mapping.

05

Repurposing

One asset becomes eight platform-native posts. Compounds over time.

01 CONTENT PRODUCTION

Outlines, drafts, and edits.

The single biggest time sink in lean marketing. Use AI to go from blank page to a credible second draft. You still edit. You still pick the angle. AI just kills the setup tax.

TOOL TO START WITH

ChatGPT or Claude (whichever you already pay for).

STARTER PROMPT

“Write a 600-word blog draft on [topic] for [ICP]. Use this hook angle: [your idea]. Tone: plainspoken, short sentences. Open with a contrarian statement.”

02 EMAIL

Subject lines, body, sequences.

Email is where structure repeats — welcome, launch, win-back, newsletter. AI compounds fastest where the format is known and the variable is the topic.

TOOL TO START WITH

Your existing ESP + ChatGPT/Claude in a side tab.

STARTER PROMPT

“Write 10 subject-line variants for an email that announces [topic]. Optimize for curiosity, not clickbait. Under 50 chars. No emojis.”

03 CUSTOMER RESEARCH

Voice-of-customer mining.

Paste in transcripts, reviews, or support tickets. Ask the model to surface recurring pains, exact phrases, and unmet jobs. Best 30 minutes you'll spend this quarter.

TOOL TO START WITH

Claude (handles long context best) or NotebookLM.

STARTER PROMPT

“Here are 20 customer interview transcripts. Extract the 5 most common pains in the words customers actually used. Quote 3 customers per pain.”

04 CALENDAR & OPS

Planning and content mapping.

AI is excellent at translating a strategy into a calendar — what posts, on what platform, in what cadence — once you've told it the inputs. Cuts planning meetings in half.

TOOL TO START WITH

Claude/ChatGPT + Notion (or Google Sheets).

STARTER PROMPT

“Build me a 4-week content calendar for [ICP]. Inputs: 2 blog posts, 1 newsletter, 3 LinkedIn posts/week. Pillars: [your 3 pillars]. Output as a table.”

05 REPURPOSING

One asset → eight outputs.

Take the best thing you made this month and turn it into LinkedIn posts, an X thread, three short-form video scripts, an email, and a landing page hook. This is where leverage compounds.

TOOL TO START WITH

ChatGPT/Claude (whichever you use most).

STARTER PROMPT

“Here's a 1,200-word blog post. Repurpose into: 3 LinkedIn posts in my voice, 1 X thread (8 tweets), 1 newsletter intro, 3 Reels hooks. Keep my voice plainspoken.”

The unlock you'll feel first

Pick ONE of the five this week. Not all five. Not your favorite three. Compounding starts at one. Burnout starts at five.

Seven days to a working habit.

30–45 min/day. By Sunday you'll have shipped a real piece of work and a real workflow.

DAY 1 **Set the table.**

Open a single chat window. Paste in: your ICP, your offer, your brand voice (3 lines). Save it as a system prompt or pinned message you'll reuse all week.

DAY 2 **Mine the customer.**

Run the customer-research prompt (Place 03). Save the 5 pains as your master file. You'll use them every day this week.

DAY 3 **Draft something real.**

Use the content prompt (Place 01) to draft a blog post or LinkedIn post about the #1 pain you found on Day 2. Edit it. Ship it.

DAY 4 **Write five subject lines.**

Use the email prompt (Place 02) to draft 10 variants. Pick 2. Send a real email to your list. Measure the open rate vs. your average.

DAY 5 **Build the calendar.**

Use the calendar prompt (Place 04) to plan the next 4 weeks. Don't overthink. The calendar will change. Just get it down.

DAY 6 **Repurpose Day 3.**

Take the post you shipped on Day 3 and run the repurpose prompt (Place 05). Schedule the next 5 days of social from that one asset.

DAY 7 **Audit + decide.**

Look at what worked. Pick the ONE workflow you'll keep doing weekly. Delete the rest from your routine. Compounding starts here.

Copy. Paste. Ship.

Ten prompts pulled from real lean-team marketing work. Swap your inputs in the brackets and go.

PROMPT 01 The ICP Sharpener

When to use: When your positioning feels mushy.

Prompt:

“Here’s how I describe my customer today: [paste]. Tear it apart. Where’s it generic? Where would 80% of B2B founders write the same thing? Rewrite it 3 ways, each tighter and more specific.”

PROMPT 02 The Voice-of-Customer Miner

When to use: Anytime you have transcripts or reviews.

Prompt:

“Here are [X] customer interview transcripts. Extract the 5 most common pains, in the customers’ actual words. Quote 2 customers per pain. Flag any unmet jobs nobody’s solving.”

PROMPT 03 The 30-Second Hook Generator

When to use: Before writing any blog or post.

Prompt:

“Give me 12 hook variants for content on [topic] aimed at [ICP]. Mix: contrarian takes, surprising stats, personal stories, and questions. No clickbait. Under 12 words each.”

PROMPT 04 The Blog-Post-in-15-Minutes

When to use: When you owe content and have no time.

Prompt:

“Write a 700-word blog draft on [topic]. Audience: [ICP]. Use this hook: [pick from prompt 03]. Tone: plainspoken, short sentences. Skip intros. Open mid-thought.”

PROMPT 05 The Newsletter Spine

When to use: Weekly/monthly newsletter writing.

Prompt:

“Draft a 250-word newsletter intro for [ICP]. The takeaway: [your one idea]. Open with a moment, not a meta-comment. End with one practical action they can take today.”

PROMPT 06 The Subject Line Stress-Test

When to use: Every email you send.

Prompt:

“Here's my subject line: [paste]. Write 10 variants that compete with it. Mix curiosity, specificity, and benefit. Under 50 chars. No emojis. Flag the 3 strongest and tell me why.”

PROMPT 07 The Launch Sequence Skeleton

When to use: Any product, course, or offer launch.

Prompt:

“Build me a 5-email launch sequence for [product]. Audience: [ICP]. Days: announce, story, objection, social proof, last call. Keep each email under 200 words. Plainspoken tone.”

PROMPT 08 The Repurpose Engine

When to use: After publishing anything substantial.

Prompt:

“Here's a [blog/podcast/talk]. Repurpose into: 3 LinkedIn posts (my voice), 1 X thread (8 tweets), 3 Reels hooks, 1 newsletter intro. Don't paraphrase — pull the strongest individual ideas out.”

PROMPT 09 The Landing-Page Hero

When to use: Drafting a sales page or product page.

Prompt:

“Write 5 hero blocks (headline + 1-line subhead + CTA) for [offer]. Audience: [ICP]. Vary: claim-forward, story-forward, problem-forward, comparison-forward, contrarian.”

PROMPT 10 The Weekly Review

When to use: Every Friday.

Prompt:

“Here's what I shipped this week: [list]. Here's the goal: [outcome]. Roast my week. What was busywork? What was leverage? What should I cut from next week's plan?”

Three metrics. That's it.

If you can't move these, you don't have an AI workflow yet — you have a habit of opening ChatGPT.

Time-to-first-draft

From “I need to write X” to “I have a draft I can edit.” Goal: under 5 minutes.

If you're spending more than 10 minutes setting up the prompt, your system prompt isn't good enough yet. Save the version that works.

Output per week

Posts shipped. Emails sent. Drafts edited. Count whatever your business actually needs more of.

Don't measure “time saved.” Measure work shipped. Time saved is invisible. Work shipped pays.

Quality drift

Compare a piece of AI-assisted content to a piece you wrote start-to-finish 3 months ago. Honest read.

If quality dropped, your editing standards slipped. Tighten the second-draft pass, don't blame the model.

Five traps that eat your time.

01. Auto-publishing slop.

“It's good enough” is not a brand strategy. Every AI-assisted piece still needs a human edit pass. If you skip it, your audience can tell — and so can the search algorithms now.

02. Replacing strategy with prompts.

AI is faster than a junior hire. It is not smarter than you. If you don't know what your customer needs, no prompt fixes that. Do the customer research first.

03. Tool-hopping every week.

There's a new wrapper app every Tuesday. The leverage is in the workflow, not the tool. Pick ChatGPT or Claude and stay for 90 days before you switch.

04. Writing from scratch every time.

If you're re-explaining your ICP, brand voice, and product to AI on every prompt, you're paying the setup tax forever. Save a system prompt. Reuse it.

05. Skipping the editing pass.

AI's first draft is the floor, not the ceiling. The editing is where your taste shows up. Five extra minutes per piece is what separates lean-team output from slop.

Pick your next rung.

If this playbook was useful, here's how to keep going. Free → low-ticket → operating system → 1:1.

FREE

The Starter Kit

7 AI prompts that replace a \$5K/month marketing hire.

seedscale.agency/start →

\$27

The AI Business Blueprint

13-chapter guide to building a digital business with AI. Includes a 30-day action plan.

seedscale.agency/start →

\$149

The Lean Marketing OS

A marketing department in a Notion doc. AI prompts, email templates, 12-month calendar, landing pages.

seedscale.agency →

90-MIN

1:1 Coaching Call

Bring one specific marketing problem. Leave with a written action plan you can ship this week.

seedscale.agency/start →

ONGOING

Fractional CMO

For teams ready to embed a senior operator who runs strategy and execution.

seedscale.agency/connect →

Marketing leverage for lean teams.

The output of a 10-person marketing team
— without hiring one.

ABOUT REBECCA

Rebecca is the founder of Seedscale. She spent 15+ years building digital systems for organizations with tens of millions of subscribers — raising tens of millions in digital revenue, growing audiences into the millions. Today she packages those systems for solo founders, in-house marketers, and fractional CMOs who want big-team output without big-team headcount.



Start at seedscale.agency

© 2026 Seedscale Agency · rebecca@seedscale.agency